

STATE OF NEW JERSEY

v.

SARA RAY & MANUEL CARAM

CASE FILING BINDER

Docket Nos. 0911-S-2024-193 / 194

Weehawken Municipal Court

Sara Ray, Pro Se

sr3768@columbia.edu | (732) 429-7793

Confidential ? Prepared for Attorney Review

TAB 1

Motion for Recusal

Hon. Lauren R. Olivieri ? Filed March 21, 2026

State v. Ray & Caram | Docket 0911-S-2024-193/194

SARA RAY, *Pro Se*
(732) 429-7793
sr3768@columbia.edu
Defendant, *Pro Se*

STATE OF NEW JERSEY,

Plaintiff,

vs.

SARA RAY and MANUEL CARAM,

Defendants.

MUNICIPAL COURT OF THE
TOWNSHIP OF WEEHAWKEN
HUDSON COUNTY

Docket Nos. 0911-S-2024-193
0911-S-2024-194
0911-S-2025-000092

**DEFENDANT SARA RAY'S
MOTION FOR DISQUALIFICATION
OF HON. LAUREN R. OLIVIERI
PURSUANT TO R. 1:12-2**

TO: Weehawken Municipal Court, 400 Park Avenue, Weehawken, NJ 07086

Carmine Lofaro, Esq., clofaro@newjerseylawyers.law

SIR:

PLEASE TAKE NOTICE that Defendant Sara Ray, *pro se*, moves pursuant to R. 1:12-2 and R. 1:12-1(g) for the disqualification of Hon. Lauren R. Olivieri from all further proceedings in the above-captioned matters. This motion is returnable at the April 22, 2026 hearing, or at such other time as the Court may direct.

This motion is based upon the accompanying Memorandum of Law and Certification of Sara Ray, and upon the full record of these proceedings.

In the event disqualification is granted, Defendant further requests that this Court refer the matter to the Assignment Judge of the Hudson Vicinage pursuant to R. 1:12-3(a) for designation of a replacement judge and transfer of venue pursuant to R. 7:8-2(b).

Respectfully submitted,

Sara Ray

Sara Ray, *Pro Se*

Dated: March 21, 2026

CERTIFICATION OF SERVICE

I certify that on March 21, 2026, I served a copy of the within Motion, Memorandum of Law, Certification, and Exhibits upon Carmine Lofaro, Esq., via electronic mail at clofaro@newjerseylawyers.law.

I further certify that on the same date, I filed the original with the Weehawken Municipal Court via JEDS electronic filing.

Respectfully submitted,

Sara Ray

Sara Ray, *Pro Se*

Dated: March 21, 2026

SARA RAY, *Pro Se*
(732) 429-7793
sr3768@columbia.edu
Defendant, *Pro Se*

STATE OF NEW JERSEY,

Plaintiff,

vs.

SARA RAY and MANUEL CARAM,

Defendants.

MUNICIPAL COURT OF THE
TOWNSHIP OF WEEHAWKEN
HUDSON COUNTY

Docket Nos. 0911-S-2024-193
0911-S-2024-194
0911-S-2025-000092

MEMORANDUM OF LAW IN SUPPORT OF
MOTION FOR DISQUALIFICATION OF HON. LAUREN R. OLIVIERI

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

Defendant Sara Ray moves for the disqualification of Hon. Lauren R. Olivieri from all proceedings in the above-captioned matters pursuant to R. 1:12-1(g) and R. 1:12-2. These petty disorderly persons charges have been pending for approximately 550 days across 16 court appearances without proceeding to trial. The grounds for disqualification are grounded entirely in documented courtroom conduct: a pattern of disparate treatment, prejudgment, and procedural irregularities across multiple hearings that, taken together, would cause a reasonable, fully informed person to doubt the impartiality of these proceedings.

POINT I
THE LEGAL STANDARD FOR DISQUALIFICATION

R. 1:12-1(g) mandates that a judge shall be disqualified and shall not sit in any matter “when there is any other reason which might preclude a fair and unbiased hearing and

judgment, or which might reasonably lead counsel or the parties to believe so.”

The standard is objective. Disqualification is required when a “reasonable, fully informed person would have doubts about the judge’s impartiality.” *State v. McCabe*, 201 N.J. 34, 44-45 (2010). Proof of actual bias is not required — the appearance of partiality is itself sufficient. *Id.*; Canon 3(E)(1), Code of Judicial Conduct. “[J]udges are required to maintain, enforce, and observe ‘high standards of conduct so that the integrity and independence of the judiciary may be preserved.’” N.J. Code of Judicial Conduct, Canon 1.

POINT II

DISQUALIFICATION IS REQUIRED

A. A Pattern of Disparate Treatment Establishes an Objectively Reasonable Appearance of Partiality.

The following incidents, drawn from hearings on January 21, 2026 and March 18, 2026, demonstrate a consistent pattern in which Defendant was treated less favorably than opposing counsel under materially identical circumstances. Each incident is independently sufficient under *McCabe*. Their cumulative effect is compelling.

1. Defendant Was Denied Remote Appearance and Required to Appear in Person While Opposing Counsel and the Complainant Appeared Virtually at the Same Hearing.

On January 20, 2026, Defendant contacted the Weehawken Municipal Court to inquire whether she could appear remotely at the January 21, 2026 hearing. Court staff advised that remote appearance was not available. Defendant appeared in person as required. At that same hearing, however, opposing counsel Carmine Lofaro, Esq. and the complainant Brian Mukamal both appeared virtually. (Certification ¶4.)

The physical burden of in-person appearance — travel, time, cost — was imposed exclusively on the unrepresented defendant. That the same accommodation was

simultaneously extended to represented opposing counsel and the complaining party, but denied to Defendant when she requested it the day before, reflects a procedural asymmetry that a reasonable, fully informed person would find difficult to reconcile with the appearance of impartiality.

2. At the Same Hearing, the Court Disparaged Defendant’s Exercise of Her Right to Proceed Pro Se.

At the January 21, 2026 hearing — the same appearance at which remote access was denied to Defendant but granted to the opposing side — Judge Olivieri stated in open court, directed at Defendant, in substance, that Defendant needed to hire an attorney because “that is why they go to school for an extra three years.” (Certification ¶15.)

The right to proceed without counsel is expressly preserved by R. 1:21-1(a). A judge may not communicate to a litigant, on the record, that her choice to exercise that right is inadequate or unwise. The comment, made on the same day Defendant was denied a procedural accommodation freely given to the other side, reinforces the appearance of disparate treatment. Taken together, these two incidents at the January 21, 2026 hearing — one procedural, one expressive — establish a pattern that satisfies the objective standard of *McCabe*.

3. The Court Communicated Its Intended Ruling to Opposing Counsel Before Defendant Had Been Heard.

At the March 18, 2026 hearing, while all parties were before the court on the record, Judge Olivieri made a statement directed at Mr. Lofaro to the effect that she was going to find that Defendant had caused the delay in the cross-complaint proceedings — as the stated basis for: (1) granting Mr. Lofaro’s motion to dismiss Defendant’s cross-complaint; and (2) denying Defendant’s pending Speedy Trial Motion. The judge appeared to nod toward Mr. Lofaro as she made this statement. Defendant had not yet been heard on either matter. (Certification ¶16.)

Communicating an intended ruling to one party before the other has been heard is the procedural definition of prejudgment. The factual premise underlying the intended ruling is also unsupported by the record: Defendant's cross-complaint was filed on June 5, 2025, eighty-nine days before the applicable one-year limitations period. The gap between that filing and the court's November 25, 2025 probable cause finding reflects the court's own processing timeline. No act or omission by Defendant accounts for that interval. A ruling premised on an unsupported factual finding, communicated to the benefitting party before the opposing party is heard, is disqualifying under *McCabe*, 201 N.J. at 44-45.

4. The Court Was Prepared to Rule on an Unserved Motion While Applying Asymmetric Scrutiny to Defendant's Account of Non-Service.

At the March 18, 2026 hearing, Judge Olivieri introduced Mr. Lofaro's Motion to Dismiss Defendant's cross-complaint and stated she was prepared to rule on it. Defendant had not been served with the motion and had not seen it before that morning. When Defendant raised the lack of service, Judge Olivieri asked Mr. Lofaro whether he had served the motion on Defendant. Mr. Lofaro acknowledged he had not served it directly; he had submitted it to the court and asked the court to forward it. He had not emailed or otherwise transmitted it to Defendant. (Certification ¶7.)

Rather than accepting this concession at face value, the court summoned multiple staff members and questioned each of them, repeatedly and more than once per staff member, about whether they had forwarded the motion to Defendant. Each staff member confirmed, on each occasion questioned, that they had not. The repeated questioning, in the face of unanimous answers corroborating Defendant's account and Mr. Lofaro's own acknowledgment of non-service, reflects an asymmetric credibility presumption: Defendant's accurate account was subjected to sustained skepticism that opposing counsel's admitted procedural failure was not. (Certification ¶7.)

When Defendant stated, during this process, that she wished to have an opportunity to review the motion, the court directed Defendant to stop talking. Mr. Lofaro, by contrast, spoke to the court at length and without interruption throughout the proceeding. Mr. Lofaro subsequently stated on the record, in substance, that he did not want to face an appeal on this matter later — an acknowledgment of appellate exposure arising from the service failure. The motion itself did not cite the statute applicable to the relief sought. (Certification ¶7.)

5. The Court Failed to Consult the Docket When Defendant Raised a Scheduled Contempt Hearing, Effectively Removing an Adverse Proceeding from the Court's Acknowledged Record.

At the March 18, 2026 hearing, Defendant raised a pending contempt proceeding regarding the complainant's sworn statement of February 26, 2025 — a statement that Defendant contends is contradicted by documentary evidence. Judge Olivieri responded that she had no recollection of any pending contempt hearing. (Certification ¶8.)

The contempt proceeding is documented in the record: it was initiated on April 16, 2025, rescheduled for August 20, 2025 alongside trial, and continued on that date by court instruction. Defendant's prior counsel, Geoffrey T. Mott, Esq., submitted a letter to the court dated August 2025 expressly requesting that all complaints and counter-complaints — including the contempt matter — be included in the August 20, 2025 proceedings. A true copy of that letter is attached hereto as **Exhibit B**. The court's failure to consult the record before denying the existence of a scheduled proceeding adverse to the opposing party had the practical effect of removing that matter from the court's acknowledged agenda. A reasonable, fully informed person would find this outcome, in the context of the other incidents described herein, consistent with a pattern that undermines confidence in the impartiality of the proceedings. *McCabe*, 201 N.J. at 44-45.

6. The Court Declined to Rule Pre-Trial on a Timely-Filed Speedy Trial Motion After 550 Days of Proceedings.

Defendant filed a Speedy Trial Motion on January 24, 2026. At the March 18, 2026 hearing, the court stated it would not rule on the motion until trial. (Certification ¶9.) The right to a speedy trial is a pre-trial constitutional guarantee whose only meaningful remedy — dismissal — is necessarily rendered moot if the ruling is deferred until after trial commences. *State v. Szima*, 70 N.J. 196, 200-201 (1976); N.J. Const. Art. I, ¶ 10. These charges have been pending for approximately 550 days across 16 appearances. A refusal to rule on a constitutional speedy trial motion, filed in advance of a scheduled hearing, in a matter of this age, is legally erroneous. In the context of the foregoing pattern, it is also consistent with the appearance of partiality that R. 1:12-1(g) is designed to prevent.

POINT III **UPON DISQUALIFICATION, TRANSFER IS REQUIRED**

Weehawken Municipal Court has only one judge. Upon disqualification, R. 1:12-3(a) requires the Assignment Judge of Hudson County to designate another judge to hear the matter. R. 7:8-2(b) authorizes the disqualified judge to refer the matter to the Assignment Judge for such designation, or to transfer the matter to a judge sitting in another municipality within the vicinage. Defendant respectfully requests that this Court make the appropriate referral to the Assignment Judge of the Hudson Vicinage, Hon. David B. Katz, pursuant to R. 1:12-3(a) and N.J.S.A. 2B:12-6, for designation of an acting judge and transfer of venue pursuant to R. 7:8-2(b).

CONCLUSION

For the foregoing reasons, Defendant Sara Ray respectfully requests that the Court disqualify Hon. Lauren R. Olivieri from all further proceedings in Docket Nos.

0911-S-2024-193, 0911-S-2024-194, and 0911-S-2025-000092, and refer these matters to the Assignment Judge of the Hudson Vicinage for designation of an acting judge and transfer of venue pursuant to R. 1:12-3(a) and R. 7:8-2(b).

Respectfully submitted,

Sara Ray

Sara Ray, *Pro Se*

Dated: March 21, 2026

SARA RAY, *Pro Se*
(732) 429-7793
sr3768@columbia.edu
Defendant, *Pro Se*

STATE OF NEW JERSEY,

Plaintiff,

vs.

SARA RAY and MANUEL CARAM,

Defendants.

MUNICIPAL COURT OF THE
TOWNSHIP OF WEEHAWKEN
HUDSON COUNTY

Docket Nos. 0911-S-2024-193
0911-S-2024-194
0911-S-2025-000092

CERTIFICATION OF SARA RAY

I, Sara Ray, of full age, hereby certify as follows:

1. I am the defendant in the above-captioned matters and have personal knowledge of the facts set forth herein.
2. I have been a pro se defendant in these matters since approximately August 2025, having previously been represented by counsel for over one year at a cost exceeding \$40,000, with no resolution.
3. On March 21, 2026, I filed a formal complaint with the Advisory Committee on Judicial Conduct of the New Jersey Supreme Court regarding the conduct of Hon. Lauren R. Olivieri in these proceedings. A true copy of that complaint is attached hereto as Exhibit A. I am aware that the filing of an ethics complaint does not, standing alone, require recusal. See *DeNike v. Cupo*, 196 N.J. 502 (2008). This motion rests on the courtroom conduct described herein, not on the filing of that complaint.

4. On January 20, 2026, the day before the January 21, 2026 hearing, I contacted the Weehawken Municipal Court and asked whether I could appear remotely at the hearing. Court staff advised that remote appearance was not available. I appeared in person on January 21, 2026. At that hearing, opposing counsel Carmine Lofaro, Esq. and the complainant Brian Mukamal both appeared virtually.

5. At the January 21, 2026 hearing, Judge Olivieri stated in open court, directed at me, in substance, that I needed to hire an attorney because “that is why they go to school for an extra three years.”

6. At the March 18, 2026 hearing, while all parties were present on the record, Judge Olivieri made a statement directed at Mr. Lofaro to the effect that she was going to find that I had caused the delay in the cross-complaint proceedings, as the stated basis for granting Mr. Lofaro’s motion to dismiss my cross-complaint and for denying my pending Speedy Trial Motion. She appeared to nod toward Mr. Lofaro as she made this statement. I had not been heard on either matter.

7. At the March 18, 2026 hearing, Judge Olivieri introduced Mr. Lofaro’s Motion to Dismiss my cross-complaint and stated she was ready to rule on it. I had not been served with the motion and had not seen it before that morning. I raised the lack of service. Mr. Lofaro acknowledged he had submitted the motion to the court and asked the court to forward it to me, but had not served it on me directly. Judge Olivieri then summoned multiple court staff members and questioned each of them, more than once, about whether they had forwarded the motion to me. Each confirmed they had not. When I stated during this process that I would like an opportunity to review the motion, the judge directed me to stop talking. Mr. Lofaro spoke to the court at length without interruption throughout the same proceeding. Mr. Lofaro then stated on the record, in

substance, that he did not want to face an appeal on this matter later. The motion did not cite the statute applicable to the relief he was seeking.

8. At the March 18, 2026 hearing, I raised a pending contempt proceeding regarding the complainant's sworn statement of February 26, 2025. Judge Olivieri stated she had no recollection of any pending contempt hearing. That proceeding was initiated on April 16, 2025, rescheduled for August 20, 2025, and continued on that date by court instruction. My prior counsel, Geoffrey T. Mott, Esq., submitted a letter to the court in August 2025 requesting that all complaints and counter-complaints, including the contempt matter, be included in the August 20, 2025 proceedings. A true copy of that letter is attached hereto as Exhibit B.

9. At the March 18, 2026 hearing, Judge Olivieri stated she would not rule on my Speedy Trial Motion, filed January 24, 2026, until trial.

10. I certify that the foregoing statements made by me are true. I am aware that if any of the foregoing statements made by me are willfully false, I am subject to punishment.

Respectfully submitted,



Sara Ray, *Pro Se*

Dated: March 21, 2026

EXHIBIT A

Complaint to the Advisory Committee on Judicial Conduct
of the New Jersey Supreme Court

Dated: March 21, 2026

ADVISORY COMMITTEE ON JUDICIAL CONDUCT
Supreme Court of New Jersey

COMPLAINT OF JUDICIAL MISCONDUCT

Complainant:

Sara Ray, Pro Se
190 Chapel Ave, Apt 5021, Jersey City, NJ 07305
(732) 429-7793 | sr3768@columbia.edu

Date:

March 21, 2026

Judge Complained Of:

Hon. Lauren R. Olivieri
Weehawken Municipal Court
400 Park Avenue, 2nd Floor, Weehawken, NJ 07086

Docket Numbers:

0911-S-2024-193 & 0911-S-2024-194 (*State v. Sara Ray & Manuel Caram*)
0911-S-2025-000092 (*State v. Brian Mukamal — Sara Ray, Complainant*)

I. INTRODUCTION

I submit this complaint to document seven specific incidents of judicial misconduct by Hon. Lauren R. Olivieri across two hearings — January 21, 2026 and March 18, 2026 — in a petty disorderly persons matter that has been pending for approximately 550 days across 16 court appearances without trial.

The incidents include prejudgment of a pending motion communicated directly to opposing counsel; disparagement of my right to self-representation in open court; silencing me on the record while I attempted to exercise a procedural right; a false denial on the record of a scheduled contempt hearing; observed ex parte communications; hostile questioning of my truthfulness despite unanimous corroboration by court staff; and a legally erroneous refusal to rule pre-trial on a pending Speedy Trial Motion.

Each incident is described with specificity and tied to the applicable Canon of the New Jersey Code of Judicial Conduct.

II. BACKGROUND

A. The Underlying Charges

The charges (Docket Nos. 0911-S-2024-193/194) arise from a September 2, 2024 encounter at a pool deck in Weehawken, NJ. Brian Mukamal — a former neighbor who had harassed me at a prior

residence — relocated to the same building I had moved into to escape his conduct. On September 2, he approached me and my fiancé and stated: *"I found us and we get to be together again!"* I filed a police report the same day (Case No. 24-29264, Weehawken PD). Mr. Mukamal subsequently received a notice to cease from the landlord, which he submitted as the basis for his complaints against me and my fiancé. He claimed to have video evidence of the encounter but has never produced it. The municipal prosecutor confirmed in writing on December 2, 2025 that no video evidence from Mr. Mukamal has ever been received.

I have since relocated a second time — to Jersey City — specifically to distance myself from Mr. Mukamal. I was previously represented by counsel for over one year across approximately ten appearances, at a cost exceeding \$40,000, with no resolution. I have been proceeding pro se since approximately August 2025.

B. My Cross-Complaint Against Mr. Mukamal

On June 5, 2025, I filed a cross-complaint against Mr. Mukamal for stalking and harassment (Docket No. 0911-S-2025-000092). Probable cause was found on November 25, 2025. The approximately five-month gap between filing and the probable cause finding reflects the court's own processing timeline — not any delay on my part.

C. Pending Contempt Proceeding

On February 26, 2025, Mr. Mukamal falsely stated under oath that he was out of the country on a specific date. Gym surveillance footage and key fob access records contradict this statement. A contempt hearing was scheduled before this court and subsequently continued until trial.

D. Private Attorney as Prosecutor

Throughout these proceedings, Carmine Lofaro, Esq. — private counsel retained by Mr. Mukamal — has functioned as the prosecutor of the charges against me and my fiancé. Judge Olivieri confirmed on the record at the March 18 hearing that Mr. Lofaro, not the State, is prosecuting this matter.

III. SPECIFIC INCIDENTS OF JUDICIAL MISCONDUCT

Incident 1 — January 21, 2026: Judge Disparaged Pro Se Litigant's Right to Self-Representation in Open Court

Canon violated: Canon 3(B)(4) — patience, dignity, and courtesy to all who appear before the court, with a particular duty toward pro se litigants

At the January 21, 2026 hearing, Judge Olivieri directed a comment at me in open court stating, in substance, that I needed to hire an attorney because *"that is why they go to school for an extra three years."*

Pro se representation is a right recognized under New Jersey law. See N.J. Ct. R. 1:21-1(a). A judge may not demean or discourage a litigant for exercising that right. The comment was

condescending, dismissive, and directed at me personally in front of all parties and court personnel. It is inconsistent with the dignity required by Canon 3(B)(4).

Incident 2 — March 18, 2026: Judge Prejudged a Pending Motion and Communicated That Prejudgment to Opposing Counsel

Canons violated: Canon 3(B)(5) — decide on the facts and law, free from predisposition; Canon 3(E)(1) — disqualification where impartiality may reasonably be questioned

At the March 18 hearing, while all parties were standing before the court on the record, Judge Olivieri murmured a comment directed toward Mr. Lofaro to the effect that she was *"going to say they caused the delay"* with respect to the cross-complaint. As she made this comment, she was looking at Mr. Lofaro and appeared to nod in his direction.

The comment served as the judge's stated justification for two rulings she was preparing to make: granting Mr. Lofaro's motion to dismiss my cross-complaint, and denying my pending Speedy Trial Motion — both on the basis that I had caused the delay in these proceedings.

This is prejudgment. The question of who caused the delay in the cross-complaint was a disputed factual and legal issue that had not been briefed or argued by either party at the time the judge announced her intended conclusion. The cross-complaint was filed on June 5, 2025 — well within the applicable limitations period. Any delay between filing and the court's probable cause finding was attributable to the court's own processing timeline, not to any action on my part. I had not been heard on this issue before the judge communicated her intended ruling to opposing counsel.

That the judge communicated her prejudgment through a murmured comment directed at opposing counsel — while on the record and in the midst of the hearing — is itself the concern. It reflects a comfort with the dynamic: the judge and opposing counsel sharing an understanding about the intended outcome, while the pro se defendant standing before the court was effectively excluded from the exchange.

Incident 3 — March 18, 2026: Judge Silenced Pro Se Litigant on the Record While She Was Attempting to Exercise a Procedural Right

Canons violated: Canon 3(B)(4) — patience, dignity, and courtesy; Canon 3(E)(1) — impartiality

At the same hearing, Mr. Lofaro sought a ruling on his Motion to Dismiss my cross-complaint, filed on or about March 2, 2026. I had never been served with this motion and had not seen it prior to entering the courtroom.

Before I raised the service defect, the court was poised to rule in Mr. Lofaro's favor on a motion I had never received, never read, and had no opportunity to address. The right to notice and an opportunity to be heard before a dispositive ruling is not a procedural technicality — it is a constitutional guarantee.

When I attempted to speak on the record to request time to read the motion, **Judge Olivieri yelled at me to stop talking and warned that I would have to sit down.** It was ultimately *Mr. Lofaro* who

argued that I should be given time — not out of fairness, but to avoid creating appellate grounds. The judge relented only after opposing counsel made this argument. A pro se litigant should not have to rely on her adversary to secure the right to read a motion before it is ruled upon.

Incident 4 — March 18, 2026: Judge Made a False Statement on the Record Denying Memory of a Scheduled Contempt Hearing

Canons violated: Canon 3(B)(1) — faithful and diligent performance of judicial duties; Canon 3(E)(1) — impartiality

When I raised the pending contempt hearing regarding Mr. Mukamal's false sworn statement of February 26, 2025, **Judge Olivieri stated on the record that she had no recollection of any pending contempt hearing.** She offered no instruction to staff to retrieve the docket entry, no acknowledgment that her recollection might be incomplete, and no corrective action. When I stated I would follow up, she nodded and moved on.

The contempt hearing is a matter of court record. A judge who cannot recall a scheduled proceeding should direct staff to retrieve the docket entry — not deny its existence on the record. The practical effect was the erasure of a pending contempt proceeding adverse to the opposing party.

Incident 5 — March 18, 2026: Observed Ex Parte Communications

Canon violated: Canon 3(B)(7) — prohibition on ex parte communications concerning pending matters

During the hearing, I observed the former municipal prosecutor — present in the courtroom but holding no formal role — moving between Mr. Lofaro and Judge Olivieri and appearing to brief the judge on the case outside of my participation. I respectfully request that the Committee investigate the identity of this individual and the nature of any communications with the court.

Incident 6 — March 18, 2026: Hostile Repeated Questioning of Pro Se Litigant's Truthfulness Despite Unanimous Corroboration by Court Staff

Canons violated: Canon 3(B)(4) — dignity and courtesy; Canon 3(E)(1) — impartiality

When I objected that I had not been served with Mr. Lofaro's motion, Judge Olivieri called multiple court employees into chambers and questioned each — repeatedly — about whether the motion had been delivered to me and whether my address had been provided to Mr. Lofaro. **Every court employee confirmed: the motion had not been delivered to me, and my address had not been given to Mr. Lofaro.**

The judge's repeated questioning of multiple employees, after each confirmed my account, conveyed a presumption that I was being untruthful — despite the absence of any contrary evidence and despite unanimous corroboration by the court's own staff.

I note that Mr. Lofaro did not have my address because I have been forced to move twice — first from my prior building, then from Hoboken Point — specifically to escape Mr. Mukamal's stalking. Mr. Lofaro's remedy for the absence of my address was proper legal channels — a motion for alternative service, a request through the court — not mailing the motion to the courthouse and

asking staff to deliver it. His failure to properly serve me does not excuse the deficiency, and the judge's willingness to overlook that failure while subjecting my truthfulness to repeated challenge reflects an asymmetry in how this court treats the parties before it.

Incident 7 — March 18, 2026: Legally Erroneous Refusal to Rule Pre-Trial on a Pending Speedy Trial Motion

Canons violated: Canon 3(B)(1) — faithful and competent performance of judicial duties; Canon 3(B)(8) — prompt disposition of pending matters

On January 24, 2026, I filed a Speedy Trial Motion pursuant to N.J. Const. Art. I, ¶ 10 and *State v. Szima*, 70 N.J. 196 (1976). At the March 18 hearing, **Judge Olivieri stated she would not rule on the motion until trial.**

This is an error of law. The right to a speedy trial is a pre-trial constitutional right whose only meaningful remedy — dismissal — must be granted before trial commences or it is rendered meaningless. *State v. Szima* is unambiguous. A petty disorderly charge — the lowest criminal classification in New Jersey, carrying a maximum \$500 fine — has now been pending for 550 days across 16 appearances. The constitutional guarantee exists precisely to prevent this.

IV. PATTERN OF CONDUCT

Date	Incident	Effect
Jan. 21, 2026 (#14)	Judge tells Sara she needs an attorney: "that's why they go to school 3 extra years"	Pro se right disparaged; litigant demeaned in open court
Mar. 18, 2026 (#15)	Judge murmurs to Lofaro she was going to attribute the delay to Sara; nods toward him	Prejudgment of two pending matters communicated to one side
Mar. 18, 2026 (#15)	Court poised to rule on unserved motion; judge yells at Sara to stop talking	Sara silenced during critical procedural moment
Mar. 18, 2026 (#15)	Judge denies memory of scheduled contempt hearing (Mukamal perjury)	Pending contempt proceeding effectively erased from docket
Mar. 18, 2026 (#15)	Former prosecutor observed briefing judge outside Sara's participation	Appearance of ex parte communication on pending matter
Mar. 18, 2026 (#15)	Judge questions court staff repeatedly; all confirm Sara's account	Sara presumed untruthful despite unanimous corroboration
Mar. 18, 2026 (#15)	Judge refuses to rule on Speedy Trial Motion until trial	Constitutional right rendered meaningless; 550 days unresolved

Viewed together, these incidents describe a proceeding in which a pro se litigant is demeaned for representing herself, silenced when she speaks, disbelieved when she is corroborated, excluded from the court's communications with opposing counsel, and denied the constitutional protections that are the floor of every criminal proceeding in this State.

V. CANONS IMPLICATED

Canon	Requirement	Incident(s)
3(B)(1)	Faithful, competent, and diligent performance of judicial duties	4, 7
3(B)(4)	Patience, dignity, and courtesy; duty to pro se litigants	1, 3, 6
3(B)(5)	Decide on facts and law; no predisposition	2
3(B)(7)	No ex parte communications on pending matters	5
3(B)(8)	Prompt disposition of pending matters	7
3(E)(1)	Disqualification where impartiality may reasonably be questioned	2, 3, 4, 6

VI. RELIEF REQUESTED

I respectfully request that the Advisory Committee:

1. Open a formal investigation into the conduct of Hon. Lauren R. Olivieri as described in this complaint;
2. Obtain and review the audio recordings and transcripts of the January 21, 2026 and March 18, 2026 hearings in Docket Nos. 0911-S-2024-193/194 and 0911-S-2025-000092;
3. Investigate the identity of the former municipal prosecutor present at the March 18, 2026 hearing and the nature of any communications between that individual, Mr. Lofaro, and Judge Olivieri;
4. Inquire into the status of the scheduled contempt hearing regarding Mr. Mukamal's February 26, 2025 false sworn statement; and
5. Take such further action as the Committee deems appropriate under the New Jersey Rules of Court and Code of Judicial Conduct.

VII. CERTIFICATION

I certify that the foregoing statements are true and correct to the best of my knowledge, information, and belief. I understand that this complaint will be treated as confidential. I am aware that if any statement herein is willfully false, I am subject to punishment.

Sara Ray

Sara Ray

Date: March 21, 2026

EXHIBIT B

Letter of Geoffrey T. Mott, Esq. to Weehawken Municipal Court
Re: Request to Include All Complaints and Counter-Complaints
in the August 20, 2025 Proceedings

The Law Offices of
GEOFFREY T. MOTT, P.C.

736 Valley Road
Upper Montclair, N.J. 07043
Tel: (973) 655-8989
Fax: (973) 655-0077

email: gmott@geoffreymottlaw.com
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7600 Jericho Tpke, Suite 105
Woodbury, N.Y. 11797
Tel: (516) 544-4600
Fax: (516) 544-4601

VIA TELEFAX 201-866-6850
VIA CERTIFIED MAIL, RRR
VIA ELECTONIC MAIL – weehawkencourt@tow-nj.net

August 14, 2025

Court Administrator
Weehawken Township Municipal Court
400 Park Avenue
Weehawken, New Jersey 07086
201-319-6033

RE: State of New Jersey v. Sara Ray
State of New Jersey v. Manuel Caram
State of New Jersey v. Brian Mukamal
Violation No. 0911 S 2024 000193
Violation No. 0911 S 2024 000194
Violation No. 0911 S 2025 000193
**Request to Include All Complaints and Counter-Complaints in the
August 20, 2025, Proceedings.**

Dear Sir or Madam:

Please be advised that my office represents Sara Ray and Manuel Caram in the above-referenced matters. This matter is currently scheduled for a contempt hearing on Wednesday, August 20, 2025, followed by trial on the same date.

At the last hearing, my clients advised the Court that they intended to file counter-complaints against the complainant. The Court granted them until June 6, 2025, to file, and those complaints, now assigned violation number 0911 S 2025 000193, were filed on June 5, 2025, in accordance with the Court's directive. The purpose was to allow all matters to be tried together on August 20, 2025. At that hearing, we were specifically advised that the August 20, 2025, appearance would encompass (1) the contempt hearing against the complainant, (2) the complaints against my clients, and (3) my clients' complaints against the complainant.

However, when I contacted the Clerk today, I was advised that my clients' complaints would not be heard on August 20, 2025, as they were not ready. I was further informed that the counter-complaints were currently with the County Prosecutor and have been delayed, though the

Clerk could not explain the reason for the delay, despite having previously stated that the complaints would take only 45 days to process.

Accordingly, I respectfully request that the August 20, 2025, appearance proceed with the contempt hearing, followed by a trial on both the complaints and counter-complaints, as previously directed by the Court.

Thank you for your attention to this matter. Should you have any questions or require additional information, please do not hesitate to contact my office.

Very truly yours,

/s/ GEOFFREY T. MOTT, ESQ.

cc: Municipal Court Administrator via fax, electronic mail and Certified Mail/RRR

TAB 2

ACJC Complaint

Advisory Committee on Judicial Conduct ? Filed March 21, 2026

State v. Ray & Caram | Docket 0911-S-2024-193/194

ADVISORY COMMITTEE ON JUDICIAL CONDUCT
Supreme Court of New Jersey

COMPLAINT OF JUDICIAL MISCONDUCT

Complainant:

Sara Ray, Pro Se
190 Chapel Ave, Apt 5021, Jersey City, NJ 07305
(732) 429-7793 | sr3768@columbia.edu

Date:

March 21, 2026

Judge Complained Of:

Hon. Lauren R. Olivieri
Weehawken Municipal Court
400 Park Avenue, 2nd Floor, Weehawken, NJ 07086

Docket Numbers:

0911-S-2024-193 & 0911-S-2024-194 (*State v. Sara Ray & Manuel Caram*)
0911-S-2025-000092 (*State v. Brian Mukamal — Sara Ray, Complainant*)

I. INTRODUCTION

I submit this complaint to document seven specific incidents of judicial misconduct by Hon. Lauren R. Olivieri across two hearings — January 21, 2026 and March 18, 2026 — in a petty disorderly persons matter that has been pending for approximately 550 days across 16 court appearances without trial.

The incidents include prejudgment of a pending motion communicated directly to opposing counsel; disparagement of my right to self-representation in open court; silencing me on the record while I attempted to exercise a procedural right; a false denial on the record of a scheduled contempt hearing; observed ex parte communications; hostile questioning of my truthfulness despite unanimous corroboration by court staff; and a legally erroneous refusal to rule pre-trial on a pending Speedy Trial Motion.

Each incident is described with specificity and tied to the applicable Canon of the New Jersey Code of Judicial Conduct.

II. BACKGROUND

A. The Underlying Charges

The charges (Docket Nos. 0911-S-2024-193/194) arise from a September 2, 2024 encounter at a pool deck in Weehawken, NJ. Brian Mukamal — a former neighbor who had harassed me at a prior

residence — relocated to the same building I had moved into to escape his conduct. On September 2, he approached me and my fiancé and stated: *"I found us and we get to be together again!"* I filed a police report the same day (Case No. 24-29264, Weehawken PD). Mr. Mukamal subsequently received a notice to cease from the landlord, which he submitted as the basis for his complaints against me and my fiancé. He claimed to have video evidence of the encounter but has never produced it. The municipal prosecutor confirmed in writing on December 2, 2025 that no video evidence from Mr. Mukamal has ever been received.

I have since relocated a second time — to Jersey City — specifically to distance myself from Mr. Mukamal. I was previously represented by counsel for over one year across approximately ten appearances, at a cost exceeding \$40,000, with no resolution. I have been proceeding pro se since approximately August 2025.

B. My Cross-Complaint Against Mr. Mukamal

On June 5, 2025, I filed a cross-complaint against Mr. Mukamal for stalking and harassment (Docket No. 0911-S-2025-000092). Probable cause was found on November 25, 2025. The approximately five-month gap between filing and the probable cause finding reflects the court's own processing timeline — not any delay on my part.

C. Pending Contempt Proceeding

On February 26, 2025, Mr. Mukamal falsely stated under oath that he was out of the country on a specific date. Gym surveillance footage and key fob access records contradict this statement. A contempt hearing was scheduled before this court and subsequently continued until trial.

D. Private Attorney as Prosecutor

Throughout these proceedings, Carmine Lofaro, Esq. — private counsel retained by Mr. Mukamal — has functioned as the prosecutor of the charges against me and my fiancé. Judge Olivieri confirmed on the record at the March 18 hearing that Mr. Lofaro, not the State, is prosecuting this matter.

III. SPECIFIC INCIDENTS OF JUDICIAL MISCONDUCT

Incident 1 — January 21, 2026: Judge Disparaged Pro Se Litigant's Right to Self-Representation in Open Court

Canon violated: Canon 3(B)(4) — patience, dignity, and courtesy to all who appear before the court, with a particular duty toward pro se litigants

At the January 21, 2026 hearing, Judge Olivieri directed a comment at me in open court stating, in substance, that I needed to hire an attorney because *"that is why they go to school for an extra three years."*

Pro se representation is a right recognized under New Jersey law. See N.J. Ct. R. 1:21-1(a). A judge may not demean or discourage a litigant for exercising that right. The comment was

condescending, dismissive, and directed at me personally in front of all parties and court personnel. It is inconsistent with the dignity required by Canon 3(B)(4).

Incident 2 — March 18, 2026: Judge Prejudged a Pending Motion and Communicated That Prejudgment to Opposing Counsel

Canons violated: Canon 3(B)(5) — decide on the facts and law, free from predisposition; Canon 3(E)(1) — disqualification where impartiality may reasonably be questioned

At the March 18 hearing, while all parties were standing before the court on the record, Judge Olivieri murmured a comment directed toward Mr. Lofaro to the effect that she was *"going to say they caused the delay"* with respect to the cross-complaint. As she made this comment, she was looking at Mr. Lofaro and appeared to nod in his direction.

The comment served as the judge's stated justification for two rulings she was preparing to make: granting Mr. Lofaro's motion to dismiss my cross-complaint, and denying my pending Speedy Trial Motion — both on the basis that I had caused the delay in these proceedings.

This is prejudgment. The question of who caused the delay in the cross-complaint was a disputed factual and legal issue that had not been briefed or argued by either party at the time the judge announced her intended conclusion. The cross-complaint was filed on June 5, 2025 — well within the applicable limitations period. Any delay between filing and the court's probable cause finding was attributable to the court's own processing timeline, not to any action on my part. I had not been heard on this issue before the judge communicated her intended ruling to opposing counsel.

That the judge communicated her prejudgment through a murmured comment directed at opposing counsel — while on the record and in the midst of the hearing — is itself the concern. It reflects a comfort with the dynamic: the judge and opposing counsel sharing an understanding about the intended outcome, while the pro se defendant standing before the court was effectively excluded from the exchange.

Incident 3 — March 18, 2026: Judge Silenced Pro Se Litigant on the Record While She Was Attempting to Exercise a Procedural Right

Canons violated: Canon 3(B)(4) — patience, dignity, and courtesy; Canon 3(E)(1) — impartiality

At the same hearing, Mr. Lofaro sought a ruling on his Motion to Dismiss my cross-complaint, filed on or about March 2, 2026. I had never been served with this motion and had not seen it prior to entering the courtroom.

Before I raised the service defect, the court was poised to rule in Mr. Lofaro's favor on a motion I had never received, never read, and had no opportunity to address. The right to notice and an opportunity to be heard before a dispositive ruling is not a procedural technicality — it is a constitutional guarantee.

When I attempted to speak on the record to request time to read the motion, **Judge Olivieri yelled at me to stop talking and warned that I would have to sit down.** It was ultimately *Mr. Lofaro* who

argued that I should be given time — not out of fairness, but to avoid creating appellate grounds. The judge relented only after opposing counsel made this argument. A pro se litigant should not have to rely on her adversary to secure the right to read a motion before it is ruled upon.

Incident 4 — March 18, 2026: Judge Made a False Statement on the Record Denying Memory of a Scheduled Contempt Hearing

Canons violated: Canon 3(B)(1) — faithful and diligent performance of judicial duties; Canon 3(E)(1) — impartiality

When I raised the pending contempt hearing regarding Mr. Mukamal's false sworn statement of February 26, 2025, **Judge Olivieri stated on the record that she had no recollection of any pending contempt hearing.** She offered no instruction to staff to retrieve the docket entry, no acknowledgment that her recollection might be incomplete, and no corrective action. When I stated I would follow up, she nodded and moved on.

The contempt hearing is a matter of court record. A judge who cannot recall a scheduled proceeding should direct staff to retrieve the docket entry — not deny its existence on the record. The practical effect was the erasure of a pending contempt proceeding adverse to the opposing party.

Incident 5 — March 18, 2026: Observed Ex Parte Communications

Canon violated: Canon 3(B)(7) — prohibition on ex parte communications concerning pending matters

During the hearing, I observed the former municipal prosecutor — present in the courtroom but holding no formal role — moving between Mr. Lofaro and Judge Olivieri and appearing to brief the judge on the case outside of my participation. I respectfully request that the Committee investigate the identity of this individual and the nature of any communications with the court.

Incident 6 — March 18, 2026: Hostile Repeated Questioning of Pro Se Litigant's Truthfulness Despite Unanimous Corroboration by Court Staff

Canons violated: Canon 3(B)(4) — dignity and courtesy; Canon 3(E)(1) — impartiality

When I objected that I had not been served with Mr. Lofaro's motion, Judge Olivieri called multiple court employees into chambers and questioned each — repeatedly — about whether the motion had been delivered to me and whether my address had been provided to Mr. Lofaro. **Every court employee confirmed: the motion had not been delivered to me, and my address had not been given to Mr. Lofaro.**

The judge's repeated questioning of multiple employees, after each confirmed my account, conveyed a presumption that I was being untruthful — despite the absence of any contrary evidence and despite unanimous corroboration by the court's own staff.

I note that Mr. Lofaro did not have my address because I have been forced to move twice — first from my prior building, then from Hoboken Point — specifically to escape Mr. Mukamal's stalking. Mr. Lofaro's remedy for the absence of my address was proper legal channels — a motion for alternative service, a request through the court — not mailing the motion to the courthouse and

asking staff to deliver it. His failure to properly serve me does not excuse the deficiency, and the judge's willingness to overlook that failure while subjecting my truthfulness to repeated challenge reflects an asymmetry in how this court treats the parties before it.

Incident 7 — March 18, 2026: Legally Erroneous Refusal to Rule Pre-Trial on a Pending Speedy Trial Motion

Canons violated: Canon 3(B)(1) — faithful and competent performance of judicial duties; Canon 3(B)(8) — prompt disposition of pending matters

On January 24, 2026, I filed a Speedy Trial Motion pursuant to N.J. Const. Art. I, ¶ 10 and *State v. Szima*, 70 N.J. 196 (1976). At the March 18 hearing, **Judge Olivieri stated she would not rule on the motion until trial.**

This is an error of law. The right to a speedy trial is a pre-trial constitutional right whose only meaningful remedy — dismissal — must be granted before trial commences or it is rendered meaningless. *State v. Szima* is unambiguous. A petty disorderly charge — the lowest criminal classification in New Jersey, carrying a maximum \$500 fine — has now been pending for 550 days across 16 appearances. The constitutional guarantee exists precisely to prevent this.

IV. PATTERN OF CONDUCT

Date	Incident	Effect
Jan. 21, 2026 (#14)	Judge tells Sara she needs an attorney: "that's why they go to school 3 extra years"	Pro se right disparaged; litigant demeaned in open court
Mar. 18, 2026 (#15)	Judge murmurs to Lofaro she was going to attribute the delay to Sara; nods toward him	Prejudgment of two pending matters communicated to one side
Mar. 18, 2026 (#15)	Court poised to rule on unserved motion; judge yells at Sara to stop talking	Sara silenced during critical procedural moment
Mar. 18, 2026 (#15)	Judge denies memory of scheduled contempt hearing (Mukamal perjury)	Pending contempt proceeding effectively erased from docket
Mar. 18, 2026 (#15)	Former prosecutor observed briefing judge outside Sara's participation	Appearance of ex parte communication on pending matter
Mar. 18, 2026 (#15)	Judge questions court staff repeatedly; all confirm Sara's account	Sara presumed untruthful despite unanimous corroboration
Mar. 18, 2026 (#15)	Judge refuses to rule on Speedy Trial Motion until trial	Constitutional right rendered meaningless; 550 days unresolved

Viewed together, these incidents describe a proceeding in which a pro se litigant is demeaned for representing herself, silenced when she speaks, disbelieved when she is corroborated, excluded from the court's communications with opposing counsel, and denied the constitutional protections that are the floor of every criminal proceeding in this State.

V. CANONS IMPLICATED

Canon	Requirement	Incident(s)
3(B)(1)	Faithful, competent, and diligent performance of judicial duties	4, 7
3(B)(4)	Patience, dignity, and courtesy; duty to pro se litigants	1, 3, 6
3(B)(5)	Decide on facts and law; no predisposition	2
3(B)(7)	No ex parte communications on pending matters	5
3(B)(8)	Prompt disposition of pending matters	7
3(E)(1)	Disqualification where impartiality may reasonably be questioned	2, 3, 4, 6

VI. RELIEF REQUESTED

I respectfully request that the Advisory Committee:

1. Open a formal investigation into the conduct of Hon. Lauren R. Olivieri as described in this complaint;
2. Obtain and review the audio recordings and transcripts of the January 21, 2026 and March 18, 2026 hearings in Docket Nos. 0911-S-2024-193/194 and 0911-S-2025-000092;
3. Investigate the identity of the former municipal prosecutor present at the March 18, 2026 hearing and the nature of any communications between that individual, Mr. Lofaro, and Judge Olivieri;
4. Inquire into the status of the scheduled contempt hearing regarding Mr. Mukamal's February 26, 2025 false sworn statement; and
5. Take such further action as the Committee deems appropriate under the New Jersey Rules of Court and Code of Judicial Conduct.

VII. CERTIFICATION

I certify that the foregoing statements are true and correct to the best of my knowledge, information, and belief. I understand that this complaint will be treated as confidential. I am aware that if any statement herein is willfully false, I am subject to punishment.

Sara Ray

Sara Ray

Date: March 21, 2026

TAB 3

Opposition Brief

Opposition to Motion to Dismiss ? Final

State v. Ray & Caram | Docket 0911-S-2024-193/194

SARA RAY, *Pro Se*
(732) 429-7793
sr3768@columbia.edu
Complainant, *Pro Se*

STATE OF NEW JERSEY,

Plaintiff,

vs.

BRIAN J. MUKAMAL,

Defendant.

MUNICIPAL COURT OF THE
TOWNSHIP OF WEEHAWKEN
HUDSON COUNTY

COMPLAINT NO. 0911-S-2025-000092

**COMPLAINANT'S OPPOSITION
TO DEFENDANT'S MOTION
TO DISMISS COMPLAINT**

TO: Weehawken Municipal Court, 400 Park Avenue, Weehawken, NJ 07086

Carmine LoFaro, Esq., LoFaro Carver LLC, clofaro@newjerseylawyers.law

SIR/MADAM:

PLEASE TAKE NOTICE that the complainant, Sara Ray, *pro se*, hereby opposes the defendant's Motion to Dismiss Complaint No. 0911-S-2025-000092. For the reasons set forth in the accompanying Memorandum of Law, the motion should be denied in its entirety.

Complainant respectfully requests oral argument.

Respectfully submitted,

Sara Ray, *Pro Se*

Dated: March ___, 2026

CERTIFICATION OF SERVICE

I certify that on March ___, 2026, I forwarded, via electronic mail, a copy of the within Opposition, Memorandum of Law, and Exhibits to Carmine LoFaro, Esq., LoFaro Carver LLC, at clofaro@newjerseylawyers.law.

I further certify that on the same date, I filed the original with the Weehawken Municipal Court, 400 Park Avenue, Weehawken, NJ 07086.

Respectfully submitted,

Sara Ray, *Pro Se*

Dated: March ___, 2026

SARA RAY, *Pro Se*
(732) 429-7793
sr3768@columbia.edu
Complainant, *Pro Se*

STATE OF NEW JERSEY,

Plaintiff,

vs.

BRIAN J. MUKAMAL,

Defendant.

MUNICIPAL COURT OF THE
TOWNSHIP OF WEEHAWKEN
HUDSON COUNTY

COMPLAINT NO. 0911-S-2025-000092

MEMORANDUM OF LAW IN OPPOSITION TO
DEFENDANT’S MOTION TO DISMISS COMPLAINT

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

Defendant moves to dismiss Complaint No. 0911-S-2025-000092 on the ground that the one-year statute of limitations has expired. This opposition addresses two threshold deficiencies in defendant’s motion before turning to the merits.

First, the Notice of Motion identifies *N.J.S.A. 2C:21-6* — the credit card fraud statute — as the governing limitations provision. *N.J.S.A. 2C:21-6* has no application to this matter.

Second, defendant’s Memorandum of Law cites *N.J.S.A. 2C:1-6(b)(4)* as the applicable subsection. Subsection (b)(4) governs prosecutions involving victims under the age of 18. It does not apply here. The charges in this case are harassment under *N.J.S.A. 2C:33-4*, a petty disorderly persons offense. The applicable limitations provision is *N.J.S.A. 2C:1-6(b)(2)*, which requires that “[a] prosecution for a disorderly persons offense or petty disorderly persons offense must be commenced within one year after it is committed.” The correct statute is not cited anywhere in defendant’s papers.

Notwithstanding these deficiencies, complainant addresses the substance of the motion and demonstrates below that the complaint was timely commenced.

POINT I

STATEMENT OF RELEVANT FACTS

1. On September 2, 2024, the defendant allegedly committed acts of harassment against the complainant in Weehawken Township. The incident was reported to the Weehawken Police Department at 5:16 p.m. that day (CAD No. 24-29264). (Def. Exh. C.)
2. The one-year limitations period under *N.J.S.A. 2C:1-6(b)(2)* expired on September 2, 2025.
3. At an earlier court appearance, the Court granted the complainant a deadline of **June 6, 2025** to file counter-complaints against Mr. Mukamal. The complaint was **filed on June 5, 2025** — eighty-nine days before the deadline. (See Exhibit A, Letter from Geoffrey T. Mott, Esq. to the Court, dated August 14, 2025.)¹
4. The filed complaint was forwarded to the County Prosecutor for probable cause review. Attorney Mott’s August 14, 2025 letter documents that the complaints “were currently with the County Prosecutor and have been delayed, though the Clerk could not explain the reason for the delay, despite having previously stated that the complaints would take only 45 days to process.” (*Id.* at 1–2.)
5. The Complaint-Summons (Defendant’s Exhibit A) bears a system-generated appearance date of **July 29, 2025, at 1:00 PM** — more than one month before the September 2, 2025 deadline. (Exhibit B hereto.) This date was generated by the Court’s case management system at or near the time of filing, confirming that the complaint was entered into the Court’s system well before the limitations period expired.

6. On November 25, 2025, the Court found probable cause and formally signed the complaint-summons. (Def. Exh. A.)

7. On December 10, 2025, the complainant signed the certification upon receipt from the Court. (Def. Exh. A.) The complainant did not delay — she signed the certification the first date the Court presented it to her, which could not occur until after the probable cause determination.

¹ Attorney Mott’s letter references violation number 0911-S-2025-000193, which corresponds to the broader set of counter-complaints filed on June 5, 2025 on behalf of both complainants. The complaint at issue in this motion — Complaint No. 0911-S-2025-000092 — arises from the same June 5, 2025 filing and the same underlying incident of September 2, 2024. The difference in sequence numbers reflects the Court’s internal assignment of separate docket numbers to individual charges and complainants within the same filing.

POINT II

THE COMPLAINT WAS TIMELY COMMENCED

A. Standard

Under *N.J.S.A. 2C:1-6(b)(2)*, a prosecution for a petty disorderly persons offense must be commenced within one year after it is committed. Under subsection (d), “[a] prosecution is commenced for a nonindictable offense when a warrant or other process is issued, provided that such warrant or process is executed without unreasonable delay.”

The complainant, as the prosecuting party in this matter, bears the burden of demonstrating timely commencement. *See State v. Cagno*, 211 N.J. 488, 506–07 (2012); *State v. Rosado*, No. A-0516-22 (App. Div. 2023) (“[t]he State bears the burden of proving that the offense was committed within the prescribed limitations period”). At minimum, the present record defeats dismissal on statute-of-limitations grounds.

B. The Undisputed Record Shows Timely Filing and Pre-Deadline Processing

The complaint was filed with this Court on June 5, 2025 — eighty-nine days before the September 2, 2025 deadline. It was assigned a docket number, entered into the Court’s electronic case management system, and forwarded to the County Prosecutor for probable cause review. Attorney Mott’s August 14, 2025 letter confirms all of this. (Exhibit A.)

The Complaint-Summons form (CDR-1), submitted as Defendant’s own Exhibit A, bears a system-generated appearance date of **July 29, 2025**. This strongly indicates that the matter had already been entered into and processed within the Court’s system before the September 2, 2025 deadline. This is affirmative evidence of pre-deadline court processing.

C. The Delay Was Not Attributable to Complainant

Complainant acknowledges that administrative acceptance of a complaint for filing is not identical to a judicial finding of probable cause or formal issuance of a complaint-summons. *See* Notice to the Bar, “Private Citizen Complaints in the Municipal Courts” (Aug. 2, 2019). That distinction, however, does not resolve the motion in defendant’s favor.

For private citizen complaints charging petty disorderly persons offenses, a complaint-summons “may be issued only by a judge or, if authorized by the judge, a municipal court administrator or deputy court administrator.” R. 7:2-2(a)(1); Notice to the Bar (Aug. 2, 2019). This intermediate judicial step is entirely within the Court’s control, not the complainant’s. Complainant cannot compel the County Prosecutor to act, cannot direct the court schedule, and cannot sign a certification until the Court presents it.

Every step between the June 5, 2025 filing and the November 25, 2025 probable cause determination was controlled by the County Prosecutor and the Court — not the complainant. Attorney Mott’s August 14, 2025 letter specifically documents that the complaints were delayed with the County Prosecutor for reasons the Clerk could not explain. Complainant

signed the certification on December 10, 2025 — the first date the Court presented it.

D. Defendant’s Interpretation Produces an Absurd Result

If “issued” under *N.J.S.A. 2C:1-6(d)* means only the judge’s formal signing, then the effective statute of limitations for any citizen complaint is shortened by however many weeks or months the County Prosecutor and Court take to complete their internal review — a period no citizen can control, predict, or accelerate. That reading would effectively shorten the statutory filing period by an amount determined entirely by internal court and prosecutor delay, not by any act or omission of the complainant.

Defendant has offered no authority for the proposition that court-controlled processing delay may be charged against the complainant. His Memorandum cites *State v. Twiggs*, 233 N.J. 513 (2018), for the general principle that the statute of limitations is “an absolute bar.” But *Twiggs* does not address the question presented here: what constitutes “commencement” when a citizen complaint is timely filed but delayed in the court’s own pipeline. Defendant cites no case — because there is none — holding that a citizen complainant who files within time and cooperates with every step is barred because the court’s internal machinery moved slowly.

POINT III

DEFENDANT’S OWN EXHIBIT DEFEATS HIS MOTION

Defendant contends that no operative process existed before November 25, 2025. But Defendant’s own Exhibit A — the Complaint-Summons form — bears a system-generated appearance date of **July 29, 2025, at 1:00 PM.** (Exhibit B hereto.) That date strongly indicates that the complaint was already in the Court’s case management system before the September 2, 2025 deadline.

At minimum, this creates a factual ambiguity about when the complaint was entered into, activated within, or set for processing in the Court’s system — an ambiguity that

defendant's motion does not acknowledge, let alone resolve. Defendant submitted the very document that undermines his claim, and his Memorandum of Law does not address the July 29, 2025 date at all. A motion to dismiss on statute-of-limitations grounds should not be granted where the movant's own exhibit contains evidence inconsistent with his theory.

POINT IV

DEFENDANT'S REMAINING ARGUMENTS ARE IRRELEVANT

Defendant's arguments that the complaint is "fabricated" or "retaliatory," and his references to the North Bergen matter (Def. Exh. B), are irrelevant to the narrow issue presented by this motion: timeliness. The merits of the underlying charges are for trial. *See State v. Hogan*, 144 N.J. 216, 228 (1996) (credibility determinations and resolution of factual disputes are reserved for the trier of fact).

The North Bergen dismissal was for "LACK OF PROSECUTION" — a non-appearance — not a finding that the allegations were false. (Def. Exh. B.) It has no bearing on the timeliness of the complaint now before this Court.

CONCLUSION

The complaint was filed on June 5, 2025 — eighty-nine days before the statutory deadline. It was entered into the Court's case management system and assigned an appearance date of July 29, 2025, as confirmed by defendant's own Exhibit A. The delay between filing and the judge's November 25, 2025 probable cause determination was caused by the County Prosecutor's office, not the complainant. The complainant signed the certification on December 10, 2025 — the first date the Court presented it.

At minimum, defendant's own submissions show that the complaint was in the court system and being processed before the limitations deadline, which defeats dismissal on the present record.

Defendant's motion, which cites the wrong statute on its face (*N.J.S.A. 2C:21-6*), the wrong subsection in its memorandum (*N.J.S.A. 2C:1-6(b)(4)*), and no case law on the dispositive question of what constitutes "commencement" under *N.J.S.A. 2C:1-6(d)*, should be **denied in its entirety**.

Respectfully submitted,

Sara Ray, *Pro Se*

Dated: March ___, 2026

EXHIBIT A

**Letter from Geoffrey T. Mott, Esq. to Weehawken Municipal Court
Dated August 14, 2025**

*Re: Request to Include All Complaints and Counter-Complaints
in the August 20, 2025, Proceedings*

The Law Offices of
GEOFFREY T. MOTT, P.C.

736 Valley Road
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Tel: (973) 655-8989
Fax: (973) 655-0077

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web: www.geoffreymottlaw.com

7600 Jericho Tpke, Suite 105
Woodbury, N.Y. 11797
Tel: (516) 544-4600
Fax: (516) 544-4601

VIA TELEFAX 201-866-6850
VIA CERTIFIED MAIL, RRR
VIA ELECTONIC MAIL – weehawkencourt@tow-nj.net

August 14, 2025

Court Administrator
Weehawken Township Municipal Court
400 Park Avenue
Weehawken, New Jersey 07086
201-319-6033

RE: State of New Jersey v. Sara Ray
State of New Jersey v. Manuel Caram
State of New Jersey v. Brian Mukamal
Violation No. 0911 S 2024 000193
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**Request to Include All Complaints and Counter-Complaints in the
August 20, 2025, Proceedings.**

Dear Sir or Madam:

Please be advised that my office represents Sara Ray and Manuel Caram in the above-referenced matters. This matter is currently scheduled for a contempt hearing on Wednesday, August 20, 2025, followed by trial on the same date.

At the last hearing, my clients advised the Court that they intended to file counter-complaints against the complainant. The Court granted them until June 6, 2025, to file, and those complaints, now assigned violation number 0911 S 2025 000193, were filed on June 5, 2025, in accordance with the Court's directive. The purpose was to allow all matters to be tried together on August 20, 2025. At that hearing, we were specifically advised that the August 20, 2025, appearance would encompass (1) the contempt hearing against the complainant, (2) the complaints against my clients, and (3) my clients' complaints against the complainant.

However, when I contacted the Clerk today, I was advised that my clients' complaints would not be heard on August 20, 2025, as they were not ready. I was further informed that the counter-complaints were currently with the County Prosecutor and have been delayed, though the

Clerk could not explain the reason for the delay, despite having previously stated that the complaints would take only 45 days to process.

Accordingly, I respectfully request that the August 20, 2025, appearance proceed with the contempt hearing, followed by a trial on both the complaints and counter-complaints, as previously directed by the Court.

Thank you for your attention to this matter. Should you have any questions or require additional information, please do not hesitate to contact my office.

Very truly yours,

/s/ GEOFFREY T. MOTT, ESQ.

cc: Municipal Court Administrator via fax, electronic mail and Certified Mail/RRR

EXHIBIT B

Defendant's Exhibit A — Complaint-Summons

Complaint No. 0911-S-2025-000092

(Showing Appearance Date of July 29, 2025)

COMPLAINT - SUMMONS (DEFENDANT'S COPY)

COMPLAINT NUMBER		THE STATE OF NEW JERSEY	
0911	S	2025	000092
COURT CODE	CASE NO.	FILED	FILED
WEHAWKEN TWP MUNICIPAL COURT	400 PARK AVE	WEHAWKEN	WEHAWKEN
WEHAWKEN	WEHAWKEN	WEHAWKEN	WEHAWKEN
# of CHARGES	COUNTY OF	DOCKET #	DL STATE:
201-319-6031	HUDSON	24-29264	07086-0000
COMPLAINANT NAME:	CO-DEPTS	POLICE CASE #	DOB:
SANA RAY	24-29264		
		SOCIAL SECURITY #	SBI #:
		DRIVER'S LIC. #	(c)
		TELEPHONE #	646-234-1822
		LIVESTOCK #	

By certification or on oath, the complainant says that to the best of his/her knowledge, information and belief the named defendant on or about 09/02/2024 in WEHAWKEN TWP HUDSON County, NJ did: WITHIN THE JURISDICTION OF THIS COURT, WITH PURPOSE TO HARASS ANOTHER, MAKE AN ANNOYANCE OR ALARM, SPECIFICALLY BY, WHEN THE COMPLAINANT WAS EXITING HER VEHICLE IN THE DEPARTMENT BUILDING'S PARKING GARAGE, THE ACCUSED DROVE PAST HER, THEN STOPPED AROUND THE CORNER AND WAITED UNTIL SHE HAD EXITED HER VEHICLE. HE THEN MADE A U-TURN AND SPED PAST HER AT A HIGH SPEED AS SHE WALKED THROUGH THE GARAGE. THE ACCUSED COURSE OF STALKING, HARASSMENT AND THREATENING BEHAVIOR CONTINUES.

IN A COURSE OF ALARMING CONDUCT WITH PURPOSE TO ALARM OR SERIOUSLY ANNOY SUCH OTHER PERSON, SPECIFICALLY BY, WHEN THE COMPLAINANT WAS EXITING HER VEHICLE IN THE DEPARTMENT BUILDING'S PARKING GARAGE, THE ACCUSED DROVE PAST HER, THEN STOPPED AROUND THE CORNER AND WAITED UNTIL SHE HAD EXITED HER VEHICLE. HE THEN MADE A U-TURN AND SPED PAST HER AT A HIGH SPEED AS SHE WALKED THROUGH THE GARAGE. THE ACCUSED COURSE OF STALKING, HARASSMENT AND THREATENING BEHAVIOR CONTINUES.

In violation of:

Original Charge	1) 2C:33-4a	2) 2C:33-4C	3) 2C:33-4C
Amended Charge			

CERTIFICATION I certify that the foregoing statements made by me are true. I am aware that if any of the foregoing statements made by me are willfully false, I am subject to punishment.

Signed: [Signature] Date: 12-10-25

PROBABLE CAUSE DETERMINATION AND ISSUANCE OF SUMMONS

☐ Probable cause IS NOT found for the issuance of this complaint.

☒ Probable cause IS found for the issuance of this complaint-summons.

Signed: [Signature] Date: 12-10-25

YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED to appear before the Superior Court in the county of: HUDSON

at the following address: HUDSON COUNTY COURT ADMONISTRATION BUILDING 595 NEWARK AVENUE JERSEY CITY NJ 07306-0000

If you fail to appear on the date and at the time stated below, a warrant may be issued for your arrest.

Date of Arrest: 07/29/2025 Appearance Date: 01:00 PM Time: 01:00 PM Phone: 201-795-6000

Signature of Person Issuing Summons: _____ Date: _____

☐ Domestic Violence - Confidential ☒ Related Traffic Tickets or Other Complaints ☐ Serious Personal Injury/Death Involved

Special conditions of release: ☐ No phone, mail or other personal contact w/victim ☐ No possession firearms/weapons ☐ Other (specify): _____

COMPLAINT - SUMMONS (DEFENDANT'S COPY)

Page 5 of 11 NJCDR1/1/2017

TAB 4

Reply ? Lack of Service

Response to LoFaro Service Deficiency

State v. Ray & Caram | Docket 0911-S-2024-193/194



Sara Ray <sr3768@columbia.edu>

Docket Nos. 0911-S-2024-000193 & 0911-S-2024-000194 — Notice of Corrected Filing

Sara Ray <sr3768@columbia.edu>

Tue, Apr 14, 2026 at 6:32 PM

To: "Carmine LoFaro, Esq." <clofaro@newjerseylawyers.law>

Cc: Ashley Figaro <ashley.figaro@njcourts.gov>, Prosecutors Office <Prosecutorsoffice@tow-nj.net>

Dear Ms. Figaro,

I write to correct the record in response to Mr. Lofaro's email of April 14, 2026.

Mr. Lofaro's representation that he was served with neither the original nor the corrected Motion for Disqualification is incorrect. He was served by email on March 21, 2026 at 2:34 PM at clofaro@newjerseylawyers.law. Attached hereto as Exhibit A is a copy of that email in native format (.eml) and as Exhibit B is a PDF rendering of the same, both reflecting the transmission, recipient address, timestamp, and attached motion.

As a courtesy, and to eliminate any claimed ambiguity, I am re-serving the corrected Motion for Disqualification herewith as Exhibit C. That filing (15 pages, filed via JEDS on March 21, 2026) is and remains the operative motion.

Respectfully,

Sara Ray, Pro Se
(732) 429-7793
sr3768@columbia.edu
[Quoted text hidden]

----- Forwarded message -----

From: Sara Ray <sr3768@columbia.edu>

To: clofaro@newjerseylawyers.law

Cc:

Bcc:

Date: Sat, 21 Mar 2026 14:34:45 -0400

Subject: Motion for Disqualification — State v. Ray & Caram, Docket Nos. 0911-S-2024-193/194 & 0911-S-2025-000092

Please find attached Motion for Disqualification of Hon. Lauren R. Olivieri, filed with the Weehawken Municipal Court today, March 21, 2026, pursuant to R. 1:12-2.

Sincerely,

Sara Ray

sr3768@columbia.edu

4 attachments**Motion-for-Recusal-Olivieri-2026-03-21_2.pdf**

502K

**EXHIBIT A PROOF-OF-SERVICE-LoFaro-March21-2026.eml**

688K

**EXHIBIT B Proof of Service of Recusal to LoFaro.pdf**

117K

**EXHIBIT C Motion-for-Recusal-Olivieri-2026-03-21_2.pdf**

502K

TAB 5

Preservation of Objections

April 22, 2026 Hearing

State v. Ray & Caram | Docket 0911-S-2024-193/194

Sara Ray, Pro Se
190 Chapel Ave, Apt 5021
Jersey City, NJ 07305
(732) 429-7793
sr3768@columbia.edu

**MUNICIPAL COURT OF THE TOWNSHIP OF WEEHAWKEN
HUDSON COUNTY**

STATE OF NEW JERSEY

v.

SARA RAY and MANUEL CARAM

Docket Nos. 0911-S-2024-193
0911-S-2024-194
0911-S-2025-000092

DEFENDANT SARA RAY'S PRESERVATION OF OBJECTIONS
AND REQUEST TO INCLUDE SUBMISSION IN THE RECORD

Defendant Sara Ray, appearing pro se, respectfully submits the following preservation of objections in advance of the April 22, 2026 hearing and requests that this submission be marked received and included in the court file and record for any future review, including any appeal or trial de novo in the Law Division.

1. Objection to proceeding on substantive matters before the pending recusal motion is clearly addressed.

Defendant preserves her objection to proceeding on substantive or dispositive matters while her Motion for Disqualification/Recusal remains pending. Defendant respectfully requests that the Court state clearly on the record whether that motion is granted, denied, or reserved, and that any ruling be reduced to a signed written order.

2. Objection to proceeding without a ruling on the pending Speedy Trial Motion.

Defendant's Speedy Trial Motion remains pending. Defendant objects to proceeding further without a ruling on that motion, or without the Court stating clearly on the record whether the

motion is denied or expressly reserved to trial. Defendant preserves all speedy-trial and due-process arguments arising from delay, the reasons for delay, assertion of the right, and prejudice.

3. Objection to proceeding on disputed procedural history while the court-maintained case chronology remains withheld.

Defendant requested the court-maintained chronological case history / action log for the relevant dockets. Court administration denied that request on the ground that the information requested "is not part of public record." Defendant has timely sought review of that denial through the Rule 1:38-10(b) vicinage-level review process before the Hudson Vicinage Trial Court Administrator, by written appeal dated April 14, 2026. Defendant objects to proceeding on disputed procedural assumptions or recollection while that records issue remains unresolved.

4. Objection to any attempt to cure defective written motion practice by oral amendment at the hearing.

Defendant objects to any attempt by opposing counsel to materially amend, expand, or substitute the legal basis of pending written motions through oral argument on the hearing date. Defendant preserves her objection that she is entitled to notice of the grounds actually being asserted and objects to any trial-by-ambush approach that exceeds the four corners of the written filings.

5. Objection to any limitation preventing Defendant from being fully heard on the record.

Defendant states that during prior proceedings she has experienced repeated difficulty being permitted to fully state objections on the record. This submission is therefore made in writing to preserve objections in the event Defendant is again prevented from fully stating them orally. Defendant objects to any limitation that impairs her ability to preserve issues for review.

6. Objection to proceeding without the requested hearing audio and complete procedural record being meaningfully available for preparation.

Defendant has requested hearing audio and the court-maintained case chronology relevant to disputed procedural history. Defendant preserves her objection to being required to proceed while those record requests remain incomplete or unresolved.

7. Objection concerning the status and procedural history of the contempt matter previously raised by Defendant.

Defendant preserves her objection to any characterization of the prior contempt-related proceedings that is inconsistent with the court's own records or prior scheduling history. Defendant objects to proceeding on uncertain recollection where the official chronology has been requested but withheld or denied.

8. Objection to any retroactive cure of procedural defects after Defendant's objection.

To the extent any party attempts at or after the hearing to cure a procedural defect only after Defendant has objected, Defendant preserves the objection that a late cure does not erase the fact that the issue was previously raised and not established before substantive participation occurred.

9. Objection to private-prosecutor participation absent confirmation on the record of compliance with Rule 7:8-7(b).

Defendant objects to Carmine LoFaro, Esq. appearing as prosecutor on behalf of the State unless the Court confirms on the record compliance with Rule 7:8-7(b). In cross-complaint matters, a private attorney may appear on behalf of the State only if the Court has first reviewed the private prosecutor's motion to appear and accompanying certification on the approved form, has found a potential conflict for the municipal prosecutor, and has placed that finding on the record. Defendant raises this objection because, when Defendant inquired who the prosecutor was in this matter, Defendant was advised that Mr. LoFaro was the prosecutor.

Defendant respectfully requests that the Court state on the record the basis and authorization for Mr. LoFaro's appearance as prosecutor. Defendant further objects to any attempt to retroactively satisfy Rule 7:8-7(b) only after substantive participation has already occurred.

10. Request that any ruling made on April 22, 2026 be clearly stated and reduced to a signed written order or judgment.

Defendant respectfully requests that any ruling made on April 22, 2026, including any denial, reservation to trial, dismissal, or conviction, be clearly stated on the record and promptly reduced to a signed written order or judgment.

11. Request that this submission be marked received and preserved in the official case file.

Defendant respectfully requests that this filing be included in the official court file and record.

Respectfully submitted,

Sara Ray, Pro Se
190 Chapel Ave, Apt 5021
Jersey City, NJ 07305
(732) 429-7793
sr3768@columbia.edu

Dated: April __, 2026

CERTIFICATION OF SERVICE

I, Sara Ray, certify that on this date I served a true copy of the foregoing upon the following by email:

Weehawken Municipal Court / Ashley A. Figaro, CMCA

WEEHAWKEN.MC@njcourts.gov

Carmine LoFaro, Esq.

clofaro@newjerseylawyers.law

Filed via JEDS (Judiciary Electronic Document Submission)

Sara Ray

TAB 6

Appeal of Records Denial

Filed April 14, 2026

State v. Ray & Caram | Docket 0911-S-2024-193/194

Sara Ray, Pro Se
190 Chapel Ave, Apt 5021
Jersey City, NJ 07305
(732) 429-7793
sr3768@columbia.edu

April 14, 2026

Office of the Trial Court Administrator
Attn: Kimberly Galligan, Trial Court Administrator
Hudson County Superior Court
595 Newark Avenue
Jersey City, NJ 07306

Re: Appeal of Denial of Access to Court Records

Pursuant to R. 1:38-10(b) and Directive #06-10

State of New Jersey v. Sara Ray & Manuel Caram

Docket Nos. 0911-S-2024-000193 & 0911-S-2024-000194

Weehawken Municipal Court

Dear Ms. Galligan or Designee:

Pursuant to Rule 1:38-10(b) and Judiciary Directive #06-10, I respectfully appeal the denial by Weehawken Municipal Court Administrator Ashley A. Figaro, CMCA, of my request for court records in the above-captioned matters.

I. Background

On March 23, 2026, I submitted a Records Request (CN 10200, JEDS Confirmation EF-4046709) to the Weehawken Municipal Court requesting, in the language of the form:

"All case activity logs and docket entries for docket numbers 0911-S-2024-193 and 0911-S-2024-194 (State of NJ v. Sara Ray and State of NJ v. Manuel Caram), including all filings, motions, certifications, orders, hearing dates, and any other electronic or paper

records associated with these complaints from inception to present."

A copy of the completed CN 10200 form is attached as **Exhibit B**. On the form, I identified myself as a named party in the case.

On March 31, 2026, the court acknowledged receipt and stated it was working on the request. On April 10, 2026, Ms. Figaro confirmed that audio recordings and court date notices were ready for pickup (\$40 fee for audio), but did not address the case activity log request.

On April 10, 2026, I followed up specifically to confirm that the CN 10200 request for the full case activity log remained outstanding. On April 13, Ms. Figaro asked me to "clarify docket entries," suggesting that dockets and filings were "the same" and that I might want copies of the complaints.

On April 13, I clarified that I was requesting the MACS system's internal chronological computer printout — the complete Case History or Action Log — for both dockets, not copies of physical documents already in my possession.

On April 14, 2026, Ms. Figaro denied the request with a single sentence: "*The information requested is not part of public record.*" No rule, statute, or specific exception was cited. I immediately requested the legal basis for the denial. No response has been provided.

The full email exchange is attached as **Exhibit A**.

II. The Denial Is Legally Erroneous

Under R. 1:38-3(a), a "court record" includes "any information maintained by a court in any form in connection with a case or judicial proceeding, including but not limited to pleadings, motions, briefs and their respective attachments, evidentiary exhibits, indices, calendars, and dockets." The MACS chronological case history — the court system's own internal record of every event, filing, and scheduled appearance in a case — falls squarely within this definition.

All court records "shall be accessible to the public" except as provided in R. 1:38-6 (confidential records) and R. 1:38-7 (sealed records). Ms. Figaro has identified no applicable exception under either rule. The MACS case history for a pending municipal court matter is not among the categories of confidential records enumerated in R. 1:38-6.

Moreover, I am a named defendant in both dockets and requested the court-maintained chronological case history for my own matters. On the CN 10200 form, I affirmatively checked "Yes" to the question "Are you a named party or attorney in this case?"

III. Urgency and Relevance to Pending Motions

My next hearing in both matters is **April 22, 2026** — eight days from the date of this letter. The MACS chronological case history is directly material to (a) my pending speedy trial motion under R. 3:25-4, which requires the full chronological appearance history over the twenty months these cases have been pending; and (b) my opposition to opposing counsel's Motion to Dismiss for statute of limitations in the related matter (Docket No. 0911-S-2025-000092), where the complete chronological record of every appearance and continuance is essential to establishing the procedural timeline.

IV. Relief Requested

I respectfully request expedited review of the denial, no later than April 21, 2026, and direction to the Weehawken Municipal Court to produce the MACS system chronological case history / action log for Docket Nos. 0911-S-2024-000193 and 0911-S-2024-000194.

In the alternative, if the appeal is denied, I respectfully request a written statement identifying the specific rule or authority relied upon for withholding this record from a named defendant in the case.

Respectfully submitted,

Sara Ray, Pro Se
(732) 429-7793
sr3768@columbia.edu

EXHIBIT A

Email Exchange — Sara Ray and Ashley A. Figaro, CMCA

EXHIBIT A
Email Exchange Between Sara Ray and Ashley A. Figaro, CMCA
Weehawken Municipal Court
Re: Records Request CN 10200 / Audio Request CN 12605

Date: March 23, 2026, 2:52 PM

From: WEEHAWKEN.MC@njcourts.gov

To: Sara Ray

Good afternoon,

Please see the attached forms. Use the records request for your log request inquiry and use the audio request for a cd copy of the session(s) of your choosing.

If you have any questions, please contact the court office.

Thank you,

Weehawken Municipal Court - 0911

400 Park Ave Weehawken, NJ 07086

(Office Phone) 201-319-6028

Date: March 23, 2026 (after 2:52 PM)

From: Sara Ray

To: WEEHAWKEN.MC@njcourts.gov

Thank you for sharing!

Please find attached two records requests relating to State v. Ray & Caram, Docket Nos.

0911-S-2024-193/194:

Records Request (CN 10200) — I submitted this form via JEDS today, March 23, 2026, and received confirmation number EF-4046709. A copy is attached for your reference.

Request for Audio Records of Proceedings (CN 12605) — Attached completed. I am requesting audio files (no CD unless CD is the only available option) for the following four hearing dates: March 18, 2026; January 21, 2026; June 4, 2025; and February 26, 2025.

Please let me know if you need any additional information to process either request.

Thank you,

Sara Ray

(732) 429-7793

sr3768@columbia.edu

Date: March 31, 2026, 11:02 AM

From: Sara Ray

To: WEEHAWKEN.MC@njcourts.gov

Good morning,

Just following up on this request. Is there any payment required from me to process this? Can you please confirm receipt and any next steps if required by me?

Thank you for your help,

Sara Ray

Date: March 31, 2026 (afternoon)

From: WEEHAWKEN.MC@njcourts.gov

To: Sara Ray

Good afternoon,

Your request was received. We are currently working on it. If there are fees associated, we will let you know once we complete the request.

Thank you,

Weehawken Municipal Court - 0911

Date: April 7, 2026, 4:43 PM

From: Sara Ray

To: WEEHAWKEN.MC@njcourts.gov

Good Afternoon,

Just following up on this request for audio and also the case activity log request. My hearing is on April 22 and I need these to prepare. Can you please let me know when I should expect them?

Thank you,

Sara Ray

Date: April 10, 2026, 12:58 PM

From: Ashley A. Figaro, CMCA, WEEHAWKEN.MC@njcourts.gov

To: Sara Ray

Good afternoon,

From your request, we are able to release copies of your court date notices and the audio recordings. The total fee for the audio recordings is \$40.00. The audio and the copies of court notices are ready for

payment and pick up.

Thank you,

Ashley A. Figaro, CMCA

Certified Municipal Court Administrator

Weehawken Municipal Court - 0911

400 Park Ave Weehawken, NJ 07086

(Office Phone) 201-319-6028

Date: April 10, 2026, 2:14 PM

From: Sara Ray

To: WEEHAWKEN.MC@njcourts.gov

Thank you — I will arrange payment and pickup of the audio recordings.

I also want to confirm that my CN 10200 records request for the full case activity log (docket entries, filings, and orders) is separate from the court date notices and remains outstanding. Can you please advise on the status of that request and when I can expect it?

Sincerely,

Sara Ray

Date: April 13, 2026, 1:00 PM

From: Ashley A. Figaro, CMCA, WEEHAWKEN.MC@njcourts.gov

To: Sara Ray

Good morning,

Please clarify docket entries? In my experience dockets and filings are the same. It would be copies of the complaint's? Orders come from the prosecutor's office which I believe he handed you on your last in person court date. If you need another copy please reach out to prosecutorsoffice@tow-nj.net

Thank you,

Ashley A. Figaro, CMCA

Certified Municipal Court Administrator

Weehawken Municipal Court - 0911

Date: April 13, 2026, 3:07 PM

From: Sara Ray

To: WEEHAWKEN.MC@njcourts.gov

Thank you for getting back to me so quickly.

To clarify, I am not requesting physical copies of the complaints, motions, or orders. I already possess the physical documents.

I am requesting the court system's internal chronological computer printout for dockets 0911-S-2024-193 and 0911-S-2024-194. In the MACS system, this is the complete "Case History" or "Action Log" (as noted in my submitted records request form) that shows the entire timeline of every scheduled event, hearing date, and filing entry from the inception of the case to today.

I simply need the full MACS system timeline printout to verify the chronological docket history. I can pick this printout up at the same time I pick up the audio CD. Please let me know if there is an additional fee for printing this timeline.

Thank you,
Sara Ray

Date: April 14, 2026, 11:44 AM

From: Ashley A. Figaro, CMCA, WEEHAWKEN.MC@njcourts.gov

To: Sara Ray

Good morning,

The information requested is not part of public record.

Thank you,

Ashley A. Figaro, CMCA

Certified Municipal Court Administrator

Weehawken Municipal Court - 0911

400 Park Ave Weehawken, NJ 07086

(Office Phone) 201-319-6028

Date: April 14, 2026 (afternoon)

From: Sara Ray

To: WEEHAWKEN.MC@njcourts.gov

Thank you for your response.

I respectfully request clarification of the legal basis for the denial.

I am not requesting this record as a member of the public. I am a named defendant in the referenced municipal matters, and my request is for the case-specific chronological history / action log maintained by the court in connection with those proceedings.

Please identify the specific rule, statute, or other authority on which the court is relying to deny this request to a named defendant in the case.

Thank you,
Sara Ray

EXHIBIT B

Records Request Form (CN 10200) — Filed March 23, 2026



New Jersey Judiciary Records Request Form

Request Date

Preferred Delivery

- ☐ Pick Up
☐ US Mail
☐ On Site Inspection
☐ Fax
☐ Email

Request Needed By

Part A: Requestor Identification

Last Name		First Name		Middle Initial
Address			Daytime Telephone (Include area code) ext.	
City	State	Zip Code	Fax/Email (optional)	

Part B: Records Request Processing Location

Please select one of the locations below to process your records request.

- | | | |
|--|--|--|
| County _____ | ☐ Appellate Division Clerk's Office | ☐ Office of the Administrative Director |
| Division _____ | ☐ Supreme Court Clerk's Office | ☐ Municipal Court _____ |
| ☐ Superior Court Clerk's Office | ☐ Tax Court Clerk's Office | ☐ Other _____ |

Part C: Case Identification

Case Name			Docket/Complaint/Ticket Number*	
*In Criminal and Municipal Cases, if you do not know the docket number, please provide Defendant's information: Defendant Name and alias(es), if any			Defendant Birth Date	Last 4 digits of Defendant's Social Security Number
Indictment/Arrest Date	Indictment/Accusation/ Complaint/Municipal Number	Appeal Number	Sentencing Date	Name of Sentencing Judge

Part D: Records Requested by Division

Please describe records requested as completely as possible. Include any case numbers, dates and names of individuals involved. Attach additional pages if necessary.

Part E: Copy Fees

Copy Fees: 5¢ per page letter size 7¢ per page legal size	Special Copy Requests - Additional fees will be charged ☐ Seal only ☐ Certified with Seal	☐ Certified without Seal ☐ Exemplified (includes Seal)	Are you a named party or attorney in this case? ☐ Yes ☐ No
---	--	---	---

For Judiciary Use Only

Disposition ☐ Delivered ☐ Denied ☐ Unavailable	Disposition Date
--	------------------

If request is denied or records are unavailable, explain here. Attach additional pages if necessary.

For Tax Court Records return this form to: txctrecords.mailbox@njcourts.gov**For all other requests register and submit this form to:** [Judiciary Electronic Documents Submission system \(JEDS\)](#)**For questions please email:** SCCO.Mailbox@njcourts.gov